



# Peto Web Application

PET PARENT COMMUNITY & ECOSYSTEM

OFFICIAL UI/UX REVIEW & USABILITY AUDIT

## Comprehensive UI/UX Evaluation, Flow Analysis & Mobile Usability Report

An exhaustive, hands-on review of user flows, information architecture, visual design coherence, navigation consistency, and responsive behavior across Desktop and Mobile devices.

### REVIEW STATUS

Completed Full-Spectrum Audit

### AUDIT DATE & TIME

September 29, 2026

### FRONTEND ARCHITECTURE

React 19, Tailwind CSS 4, Vite 8, Framer Motion

### TESTED ACCOUNTS

test@gmail.com & test1@gmail.com

### TESTED ENVIRONMENTS

Desktop (1280×850) & Mobile (iPhone 14, 390×844)

### BACKEND ARCHITECTURE

Express 5, TypeScript 7, Supabase Auth & Storage

## 01 Executive Summary & UX Health Matrix

During this comprehensive audit, the application was systematically evaluated across all core user journeys: guest browsing, authentication, social feed engagement, community circles, short-form reels, pet profiles, account settings, and the advertiser portal. Both desktop viewports and mobile phone viewports were tested using active authenticated sessions (test@gmail.com and test1@gmail.com).

82%

VISUAL APPEAL &  
IDENTITY

58%

NAVIGATION & IA  
CONSISTENCY

62%

MOBILE USABILITY

48%

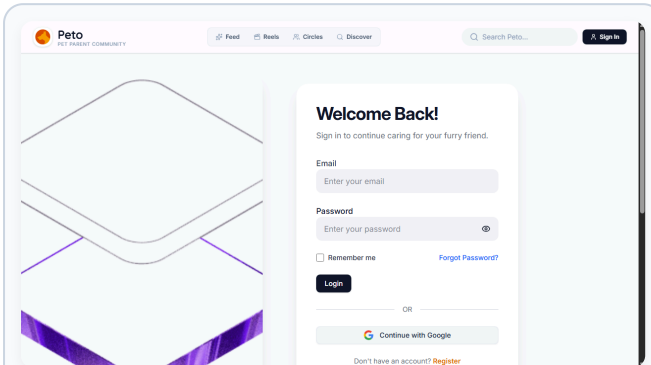
MONETIZATION / AD  
UX CLARITY

### Key Observations Summary

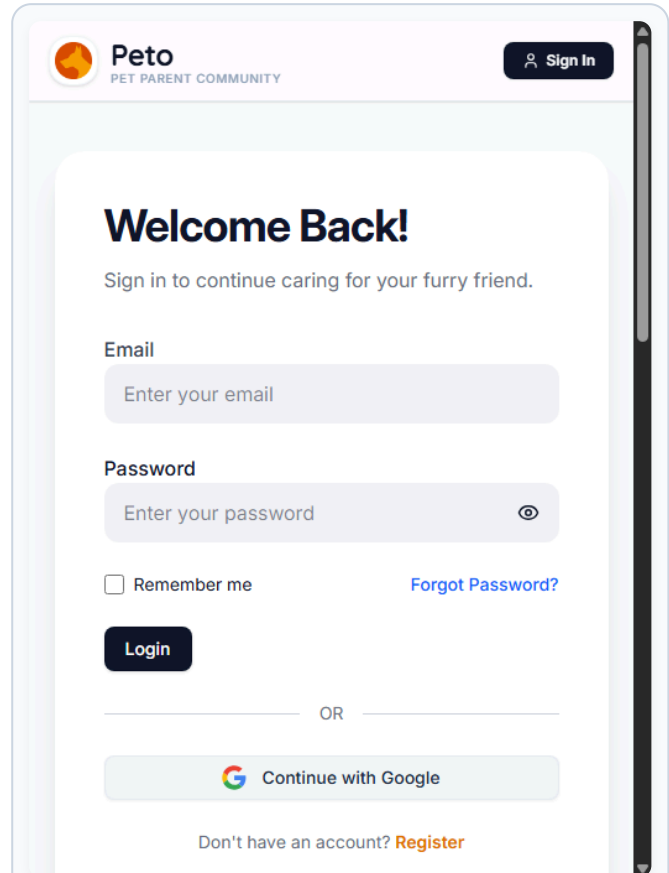
| Dimension                | Status             | Key Finding                                                                                                                                                                                | Severity |
|--------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Information Architecture | HIGH INCONSISTENCY | Triplicate naming for the same destinations ("Circles" vs "Communities", "Discover" vs "Explore" vs "Search"). Dual navigation conflict on desktop.                                        | High     |
| Mobile Usability         | CONTENT OCCLUDED   | Home feed buries post cards beneath multi-widget stack (Create Post + Region Bar + Active Pals). Feed content is 100% invisible above fold.                                                | High     |
| Authentication UX        | VISUAL HIERARCHY   | Hero image on desktop is an abstract isometric cube (unrelated to pets). Primary "Login" button is tiny, visually dominated by Google OAuth button. Redundant "Sign In" button in top nav. | Medium   |
| Advertiser & Billing     | CRITICAL DEFECTS   | Currency mismatch (₹ vs \$), unformatted raw ISO dates (2026-09-21T00:00:00+00:00), duplicate campaign creation CTAs.                                                                      | Critical |
| Component Behavior       | DEAD WIDGETS       | Floating blue Bot widget has zero click handlers, no accessibility label, and overlaps mobile bottom navigation.                                                                           | Medium   |
| API & Performance        | 404 ERRORS         | Frontend repeatedly calls /api/user/suggested (singular) resulting in 404 console errors on every home and search load. Backend route is /api/users/suggested.                             | High     |

## 02 Authentication & Onboarding Experience

The authentication flow consists of /login, /register, /forgot-password, and profile setup. While clean, several visual and navigational friction points degrade the first impression.



Desktop: Login Screen (1280px) — Abstract Hero Illustration & Dual Nav



Mobile: Login Screen (390px) — Asymmetrical Margins & Button Disbalance

### Issue 2.1: Disconnected Hero Artwork on Desktop Auth

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Screen: pages/Login.tsx, pages/Register.tsx

The left half of the authentication screen displays a wireframe isometric block (hero.png) with purple cyber accents. This completely contradicts Peto's core branding: a warm, heartwarming, trustworthy companion platform for dog and cat parents.

#### Recommended Solution:

Replace hero.png with high-resolution photography or custom illustrations of pets and owners interacting warmly. Add social proof quotes (e.g., "Join over 15,000+ pet parents sharing daily moments").

## Issue 2.2: Inverted Primary vs Secondary Action Hierarchy

HIGH PRIORITY

Affected File: `pages/Login.tsx`, `components/common/Button.tsx`

The main submission button ("Login") is styled as a tiny dark navy capsule button aligned to the left, while "Continue with Google" is a wide, 100% full-width button with a prominent Google icon. In modern UX, the primary form action should span the full width of the form or match the width of the input fields, establishing clear visual prominence.

### Recommended Solution:

Make the "Login" button full-width (`w-full`) using the primary brand gradient (Warm Amber: `#f59e0b` to `#d97706`) with `py-3 text-sm font-bold shadow-md`. Google OAuth should be styled as an outline button beneath it.

## Issue 2.3: Redundant "Sign In" Button in Navbar on Auth Pages

LOW PRIORITY

Affected File: `components/layout/Navbar.tsx` (Lines 356-363)

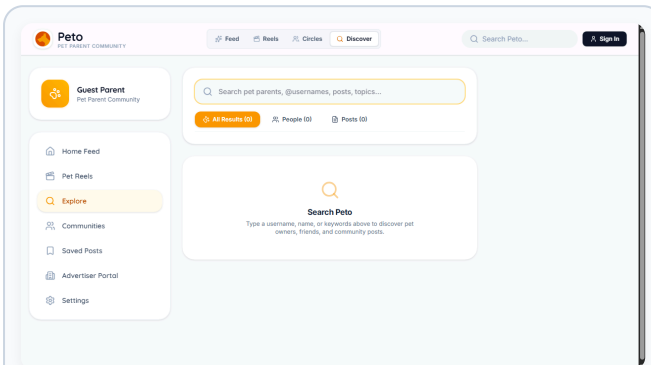
When a user is actively on `/login`, the top right of the navigation bar still renders a "Sign In" button. This creates confusion (users wondering if they need to click that instead) and wastes header real estate.

### Recommended Solution:

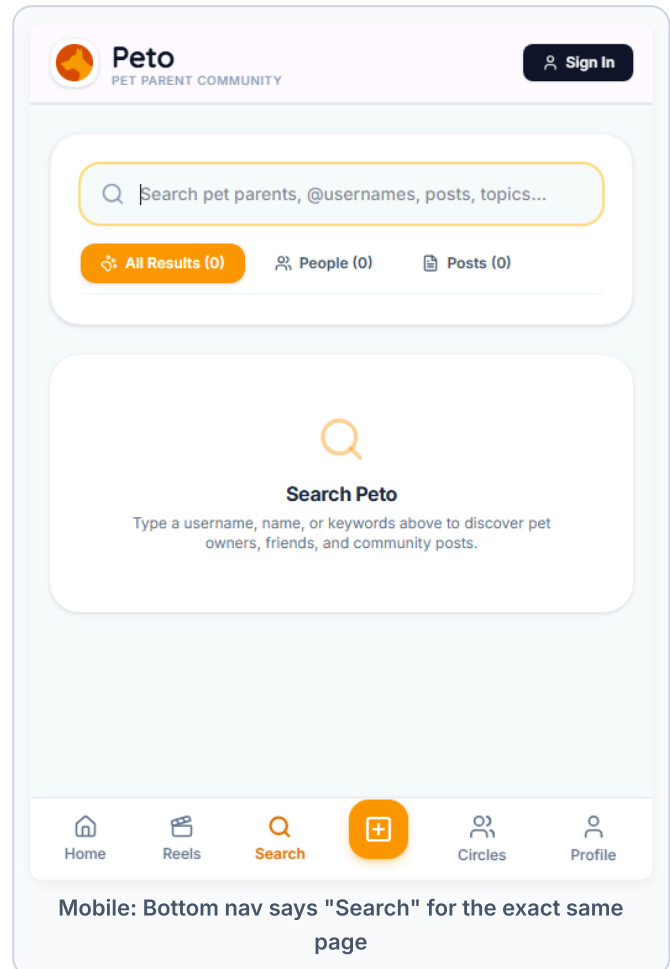
In `Navbar.tsx`, conditionally hide the "Sign In" button or change it to "Create Account" when `pathname === "/login"`, and vice-versa when `pathname === "/register"`.

### 03 Information Architecture & Navigation Inconsistencies

The biggest cognitive hurdle in Peto today is **taxonomy fragmentation**. A single destination is called by different names depending on whether the user views the desktop top bar, desktop sidebar, or mobile bottom navigation.



Desktop: Top nav says "Discover", Sidebar highlights "Explore", Page says "Search"



Mobile: Bottom nav says "Search" for the exact same page

### Taxonomy Discrepancy Matrix

| Destination URL | Desktop Top Navbar | Desktop Left Sidebar | Mobile Bottom Nav | Page Header Title                        | Harmonized Recommendation                                    |
|-----------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| /community      | Circles            | Communities          | Circles           | Connect with Specialized Pet Communities | <b>Communities (or Pet Circles)</b> — Unify 100%             |
| /search         | Discover           | Explore              | Search            | Search Peto                              | <b>Explore &amp; Search</b> — Standardize label to "Explore" |
| /social         | Feed               | Home Feed            | Home              | Feed Posts                               | <b>Feed</b>                                                  |

### Issue 3.1: Dual Navigation Redundancy on Desktop

HIGH PRIORITY

Affected Components: `Navbar.tsx`, `Sidebar.tsx`

On Desktop, users are presented with two concurrent navigation bars: a horizontal top navbar with 4 pill links (Feed, Reels, Circles, Discover) AND a vertical left sidebar with 7 links (Home Feed, Pet Reels, Explore, Communities, Saved Posts, Advertiser Portal, Settings). This creates cognitive dissonance. Furthermore, the user's profile card appears at the top of the left sidebar, while their avatar dropdown ALSO appears in the top-right navbar corner.

#### Recommended Solution:

Consolidate to a single definitive navigation paradigm. Either:

#### Option A (Recommended):

Use the Top Navbar for Global Brand & Search/Notifications/Profile, and dedicate the Left Sidebar for primary navigation across all feed views, communities, reels, saved items, and settings.

#### Option B:

Remove the left sidebar entirely on feed pages and use a clean 2-column or centered feed with top bar navigation.

### Issue 3.2: Double Search Bars Visible Simultaneously

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Screen: `pages/Search.tsx`

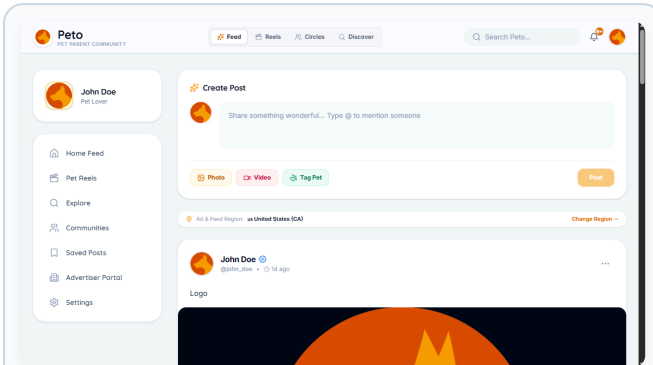
When a user navigates to `/search`, the top navigation bar displays a "Search Peto..." input box, while directly below it in the main viewport sits a second, giant search bar: "Search pet parents, @usernames, posts, topics...". Users do not know which search input is active.

#### Recommended Solution:

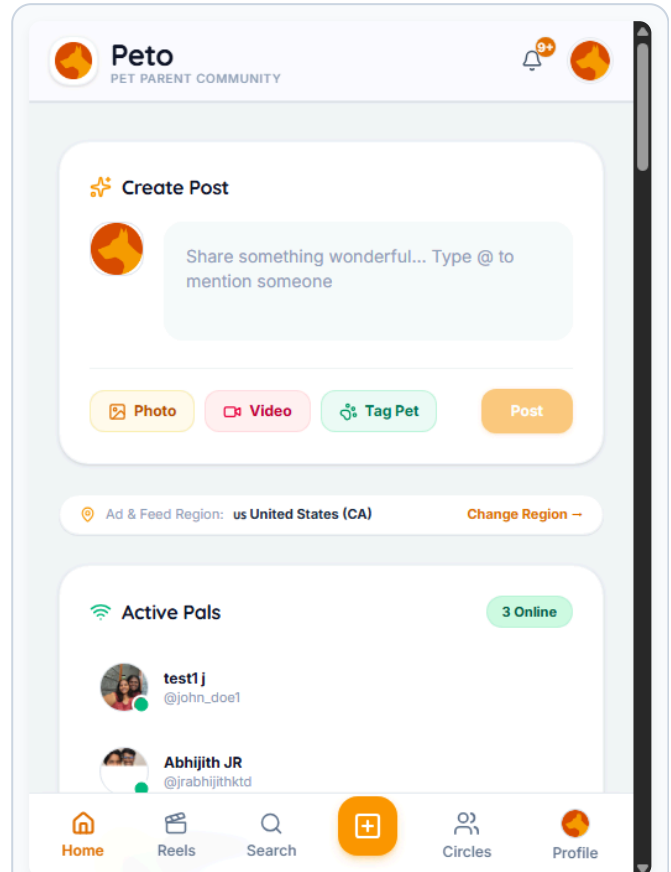
When the user is already on the dedicated `/search` page, hide the top navbar search input or automatically focus and synchronize it with the main search input.

## 04 Social Feed, Posting & Community Engagement

The home feed is the central engagement engine of Peto. While card shadows, rounded corners, and post interactions (Like, Comment, Share, Bookmark) are well structured, layout crowding impairs usability.



Desktop: Authenticated Feed — Clean 3-Column Layout with Active Composer



Mobile: Feed Above the Fold — Zero Posts Visible! Only Widget Stacks

## Issue 4.1: Critical Mobile Viewport Crowding Above the Fold

CRITICAL PRIORITY

Affected File: pages/Social.tsx, components/social/PostComposer.tsx

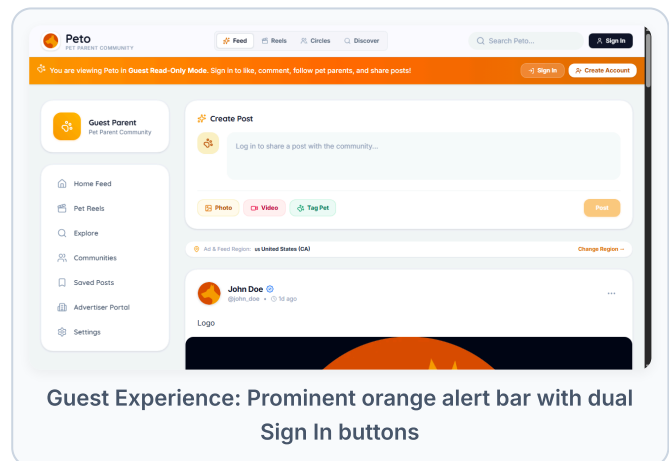
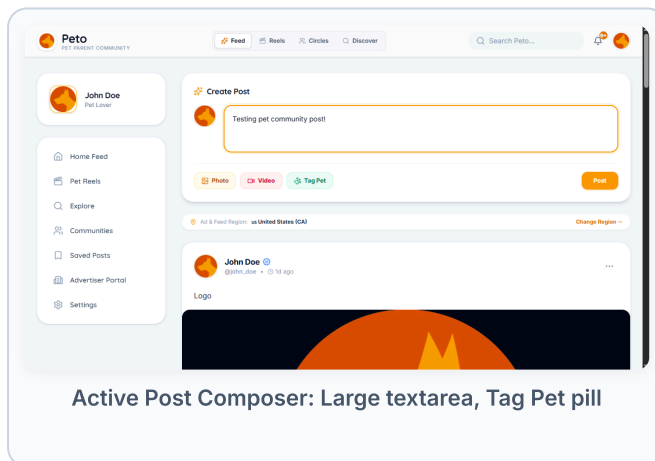
On mobile viewports (e.g. iPhone 14, 390×844), when an authenticated user opens Peto, the entire screen above the fold is filled with:

- Top Navbar (Peto logo + Notification badge + Avatar)
- Expanded "Create Post" Card (Textarea + Photo / Video / Tag Pet buttons + Post CTA)
- Ad & Feed Region bar ("us United States (CA) Change Region →")
- "Active Pals" presence box (showing online friends)

**As a result, exactly ZERO feed posts are visible to the user without scrolling down!** In social platforms (Instagram, Twitter, Threads), content must always be immediately visible upon landing.

### Recommended Solution:

1. On mobile, collapse the "Create Post" box into a compact 1-line prompt: *"What's your pet doing today? 🐾"* with a camera icon.
2. Or rely on the prominent orange + button already in the MobileBottomNav to open a full Create Post modal.
3. Move the "Active Pals" presence widget into a horizontal scrolling story-like circle tray at the top, rather than a giant vertical card.





## Issue 4.2: Composer Enhancements (Tagging, Emojis, Pet Selector)

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Component: `components/social/PostComposer.tsx`

Currently, the composer provides "Photo", "Video", and "Tag Pet". However, when pet parents post, they often want to attribute the post to one of their registered pets directly (e.g., "Posted by John Doe on behalf of Milo 🐶"). There is no pet selector dropdown in the composer header, no character count limit indicator, and no quick emoji selector.

### Recommended Solution:

Add a pet selector chip in the post composer: *"Posting as: [Milo ▼]"* so users with multiple pets can attribute updates directly.

## 05 Pet Management & Profile Experience

Pet management is Peto's core competitive advantage over generic social networks. The "Add Pet" wizard (/pets/new) and pet showcases are intuitive, but need polish for mobile form ergonomics.

Desktop: Add Pet Wizard — Clean species grid & photo upload

Mobile: Add Pet Wizard — Species icons stack nicely, button at bottom

### Issue 5.1: Pet Species Selector Grid & Mobile Scroll Fatigue

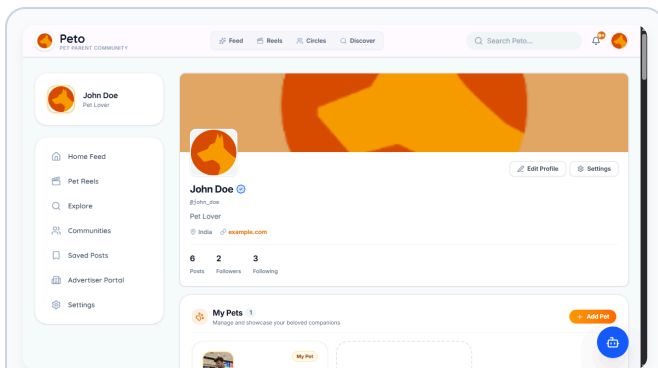
MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Screen: `pages/pets/AddPetPage.tsx`

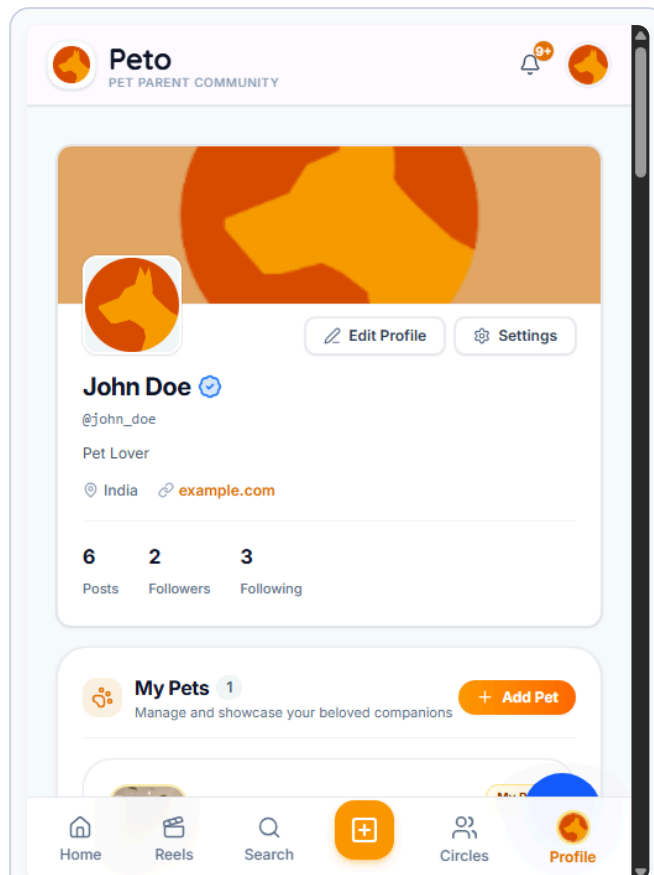
The species selection includes Dog, Cat, Bird, Rabbit, Fish, Hamster, Horse, Reptile, and Other. On mobile, this grid takes up 3 rows of large cards. Together with avatar upload, pet name, breed, sex, birth date, and bio, the form becomes very long. Users on mobile have to scroll multiple screen heights to find the "Save Pet" submit button.

#### Recommended Solution:

Implement a sticky bottom action bar on mobile with: [Cancel] [Save Pet Companion →] so the primary action is always accessible regardless of scroll position.



Desktop: Profile View — Cover photo, Stats, Pet Showcase Badge



Mobile: Profile View — Blue Bot widget occluding bottom navigation

## Issue 5.2: Inactive Floating Bot Widget Collision on Profile & Mobile Screens

CRITICAL BUG / USABILITY DEFECT

Affected Component: `components/home/FloatingChat.tsx`

Notice the bright blue circular button with a robot icon at the bottom right of the screen:

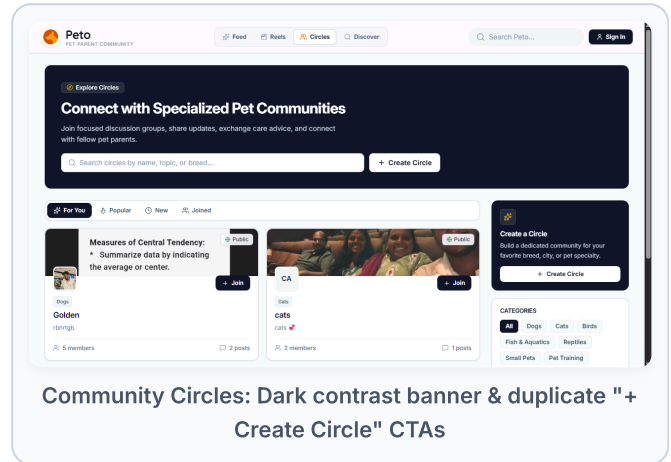
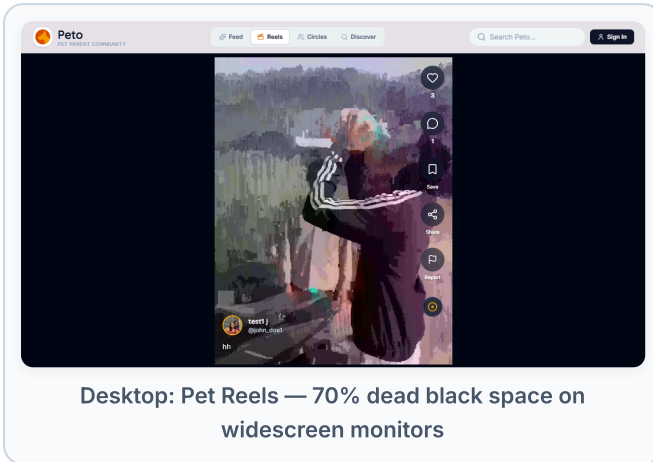
- **No Click Handler:** Inspecting `FloatingChat.tsx` shows an empty `<button>` tag with no `onClick` or modal connection. Clicking it does nothing!
- **Visual Overlap:** On mobile screens, the button is positioned at `bottom-8 right-8`, which places it directly on top of or clipped underneath the fixed `MobileBottomNav` bar!
- **Palette Clash:** Uses generic electric blue (`bg-blue-600`) which clashes with Peto's warm amber aesthetic.

### Recommended Solution:

Either hook it up to a functional AI Pet Assistant / Vet Chatbot with an active drawer, or conditionally remove it until feature completion. If kept, adjust mobile positioning to `bottom-20 right-4` to prevent overlap with the bottom navigation bar.

## 06 Reels, Short Videos & Community Circles

Video reels (/reels) and Community Circles (/community) represent Peto's two highest-engagement surfaces.



### Issue 6.1: Desktop Reels Severe Screen Real Estate Underutilization

HIGH PRIORITY

Affected Screen: `pages/Reels.tsx`

On desktop displays, the 9:16 vertical video player is centered in a pitch-black void. Approximately 70% of the viewport is completely unused. Leading video platforms (TikTok Web, Instagram Reels Desktop, YouTube Shorts) utilize this side space for:

- Comments panel (view and add comments without obscuring the video)
- Creator / Pet Profile details and follow button
- Next / Previous reel preview thumbnails and keyboard navigation shortcuts (↑ / ↓)
- Soundtrack / Audio attribution chip

#### Recommended Solution:

Redesign Desktop Reels to a 2-column container: Video on the left (or center) and an interactive Comments & Pet Details sidebar on the right.

## Issue 6.2: Duplicate "+ Create Circle" Buttons & Uncurated Card Imagery

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Screen: `pages/Community.tsx`

On the Community Circles page:

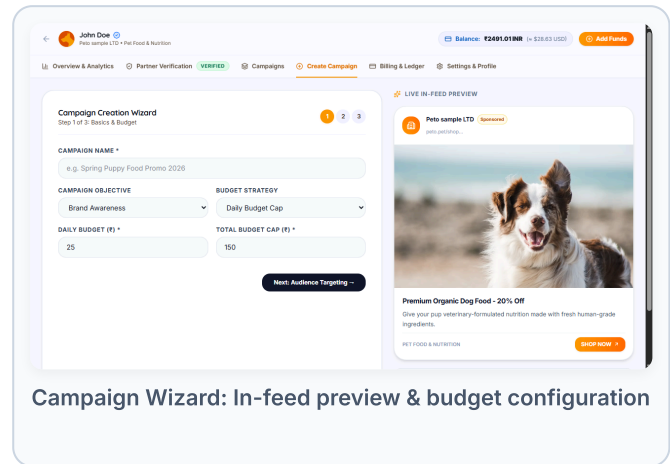
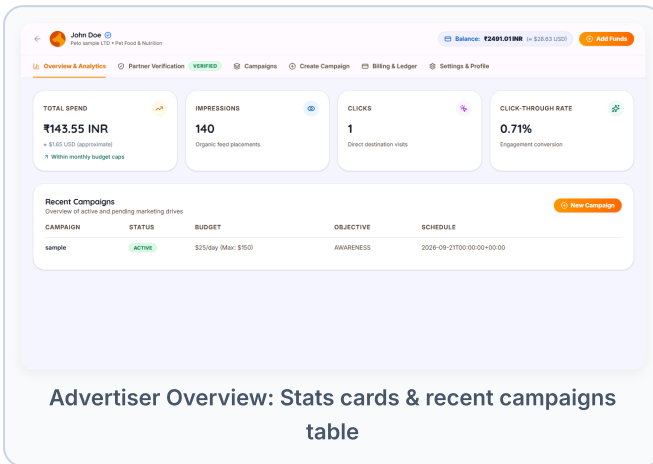
1. There are **two identical "+ Create Circle" buttons** visible on screen at once: one inside the dark header search bar, and another in the right sidebar!
2. The community cards allow users to upload arbitrary images that get stretched or cropped unpredictably (e.g. classroom lecture slides or movie theater selfies uploaded for pet groups).

### Recommended Solution:

Keep a single primary "+ Create Circle" button in the right sidebar or header. Add image aspect-ratio cropping (16:9 with object-cover) and provide delightful default pet-themed illustrated covers for communities that do not upload custom artwork.

## 07 Advertiser Portal & Monetization Flow

The Advertiser Portal (/advertiser) is a key revenue feature for pet brands, veterinarians, and service providers. While rich in features, it contains several critical usability defects.



### Issue 7.1: Raw Unformatted ISO Timestamps in UI Table

CRITICAL DEFECT

Affected Screen: pages/advertiser/AdvertiserPortal.tsx (Line 1500+)

In the "Recent Campaigns" table under the "SCHEDULE" column, the date is printed directly as: 2026-09-21T00:00:00+00:00. Exposing raw database/API serialization strings in production user interfaces looks unpolished and unprofessional.

#### Recommended Solution:

Format all dates using new `Date(scheduleDate).toLocaleDateString('en-US', { month: 'short', day: 'numeric', year: 'numeric' })` to display as "Sep 21, 2026".

Issue 7.2: Currency Mismatch Between Stats, Tables, and Forms

CRITICAL DEFECT

Affected Screen: pages/advertiser/AdvertiserPortal.tsx

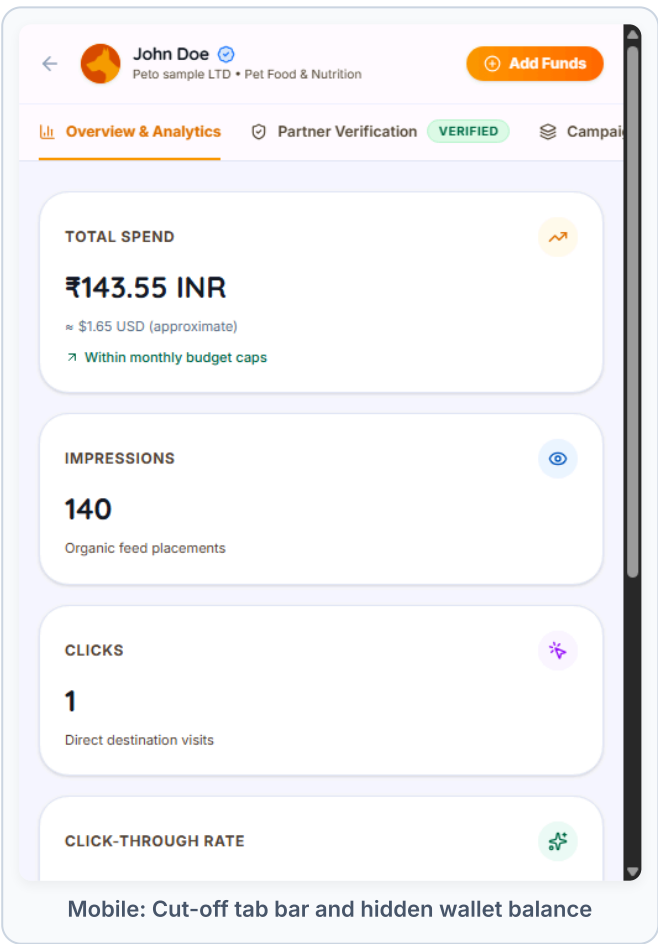
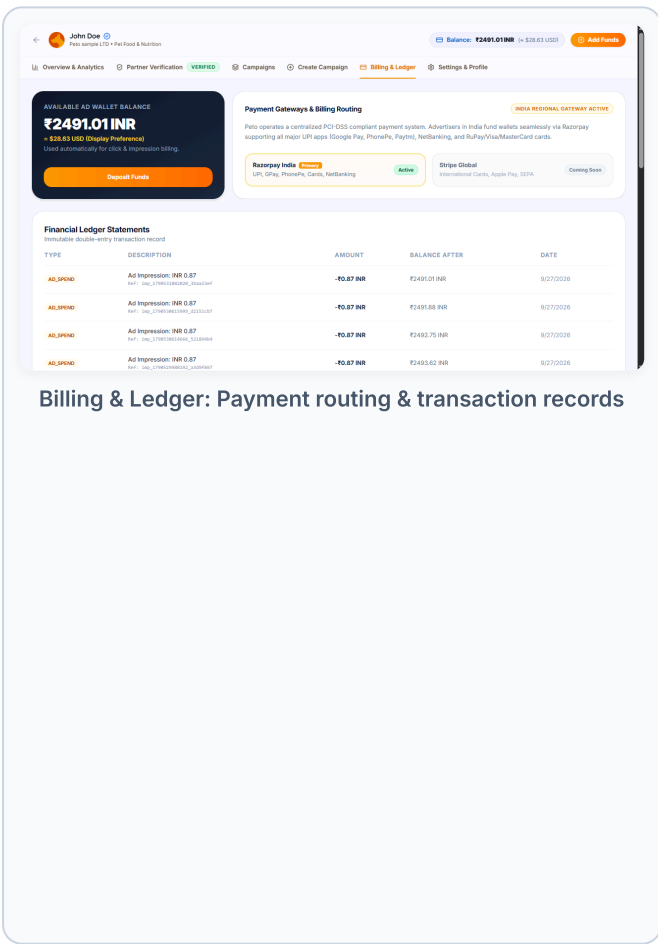
There is severe currency confusion throughout the portal:

- Top Wallet Balance: ₹2491.01 INR (~\$28.63 USD)
- Total Spend Card: ₹143.55 INR
- Campaign Table: \$25/day (Max: \$150) in US Dollars
- Create Campaign Form: DAILY BUDGET (₹) \* with default value 25

₹25 INR is approximately \$0.30 USD. Having default numeric values meant for USD (\$25) placed into an INR field (₹25) creates catastrophic pricing calculation errors for advertisers.

Recommended Solution:

Standardize currency based strictly on the advertiser's registered country / account currency setting. If the account is in INR, set appropriate defaults (e.g. ₹500/day). If in USD, use \$25/day. Do not mix symbols.



### Issue 7.3: Mobile Advertiser Portal Degradation

HIGH PRIORITY

Affected Screen: `pages/advertiser/AdvertiserPortal.tsx`

On mobile viewports:

1. The balance info (₹2491.01 INR) is completely omitted or pushed off-screen.
2. The tab bar horizontally clips with no fade indicator or scroll arrows, causing advertisers to miss the "Billing" and "Settings" tabs.
3. Terminology inconsistency: Top header says "Add Funds", left balance card says "Deposit Funds".

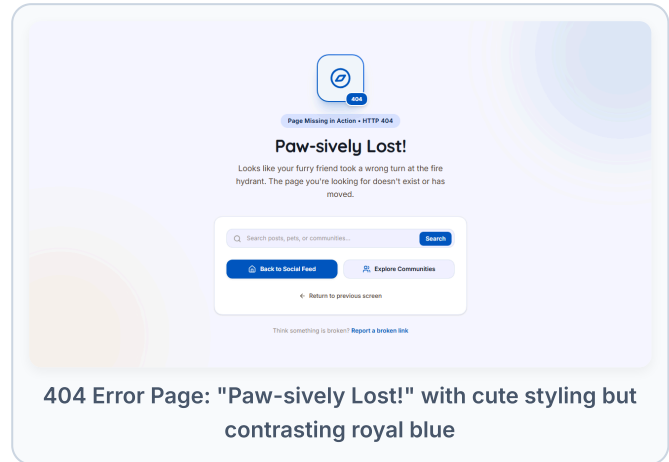
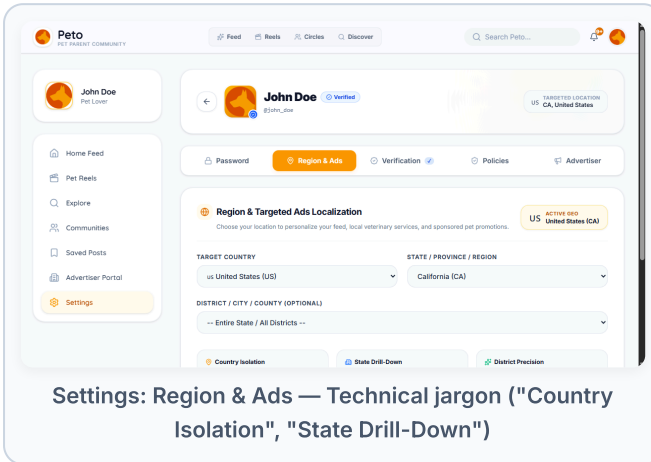
#### Recommended Solution:

Ensure wallet balance is always visible on mobile beside the "Add Funds" button. Add visual gradient scroll cues on the tab bar and unify button terminology to "Add Funds".



## 08 Settings, Error Pages & Technical Findings

This section covers settings sub-tabs (/settings), system error states (/404, /503), and runtime console defects discovered during testing.



### Issue 8.1: Overly Technical Geolocation Terminology for General Users

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Affected Screen: pages/Settings.tsx

Under the "Region & Ads" tab, the user is presented with terms like: *"Country Isolation"*, *"State Drill-Down"*, and *"District Precision"*. These are internal engineering/database concepts. Everyday pet owners who want to see local puppy playdates or nearby vets will find this intimidating.

#### Recommended Solution:

Simplify microcopy to user-centric terms: *"Show updates from: [My City / Area]"*, *"Include statewide events"*, *"Worldwide pet feed"*.

### Issue 8.2: 404 & Error Page Palette Disconnection

LOW PRIORITY

Affected Screen: pages/NotFound404.tsx, pages/Maintenance503.tsx

The 404 page ("Paw-sively Lost!") features witty pet-themed copy, which is excellent UX! However, the button styles and status pill use corporate royal blue (#0058be) rather than Peto's warm amber brand palette, making the page feel disconnected from the rest of the application.

#### Recommended Solution:

Update the "Back to Social Feed" CTA to use Peto's primary amber button style.

### Issue 8.3: Recurring 404 Console Errors from Broken Endpoint

HIGH PRIORITY (TECHNICAL DEFECT)

Affected Code: Frontend/Peto\_user/src/components/social/OnlineFriends.tsx or Sidebar.tsx

During automated browser inspection, the console consistently logged:

GET http://localhost:5000/api/user/suggested?page=1&limit=20 404 (Not Found)

AxiosError: Request failed with status code 404 "Failed to load suggested friends"

The frontend requests the singular /api/user/suggested, whereas the backend Express server mounts user routes under /api/users (plural).

#### Recommended Solution:

Update the API call in the frontend from `api.get("/user/suggested")` to `api.get("/users/suggested")`.

## 09 Prioritized Action Plan & Implementation Roadmap

To achieve a cohesive, intuitive, and delightful pet parent experience, improvements should be executed in three strategic phases:

1

### Phase 1: Quick Wins & Critical Fixes (Sprint 1)

- **Fix Broken API Route:** Change `/api/user/suggested` to `/api/users/suggested` to eliminate 404 console errors.
- **Format Advertiser Dates:** Replace raw ISO timestamps (`2026-09-21T00:00:00+00:00`) with clean localized date strings.
- **Fix Currency Mismatch:** Align budget currency symbols and default numbers across campaigns and wallet.
- **De-clutter Auth Pages:** Hide redundant "Sign In" button in header on `/login`; replace `hero.png` with pet imagery.
- **Fix Floating Bot Widget:** Remove inactive blue button or reposition above mobile nav (bottom-20) with an active modal.

2

### Phase 2: Mobile Usability & Navigation Harmonization (Sprint 2)

- **Unify Terminology:** Pick "Communities" and "Explore" and apply them across top bar, sidebar, and mobile nav.
- **Collapse Mobile Composer:** Replace the massive 400px Create Post box on mobile with a compact tap bar or modal triggered by the bottom + button.
- **Horizontal Active Friends Tray:** Convert the vertical "Active Pals" box on mobile to a compact horizontal circular avatar bar.
- **Sticky Actions on Mobile Forms:** Add a sticky footer with "Save / Submit" on `/pets/new` and profile edit screens.

3

### Phase 3: Experience Polish & Feature Expansion (Sprint 3)

- **Reels Desktop 2-Column Redesign:** Add a side panel for comments, pet profile, and soundtrack info to utilize empty widescreen space.
- **Composer Pet Attribution:** Allow users to select which registered pet the post is about ("*Posting for Bella 🐾*").
- **Design System Color Tokens:** Clean up random blue accents across verification tabs and error pages to strictly follow `DESIGN.md` tokens.

**Conclusion & Next Steps:** Peto has a strong, modern technical foundation (React 19, Tailwind, Supabase) and charming domain appeal for pet lovers. Addressing navigation taxonomy, mobile viewport clutter, and advertiser currency formatting will elevate Peto from a promising prototype to a world-class, production-ready pet social ecosystem.